- Output
- Storage

Each of this stage performs specific function which is enumerated below:

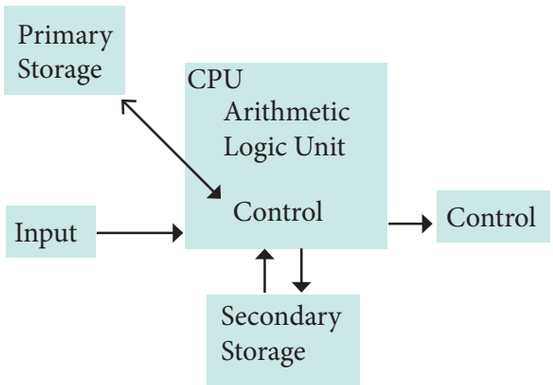

Fig.6.5. Components of EDP

Input: A computer must receive both program statements and data to solve problems. The entry of program statements and data into a computer occurs by means of an input device such as keyboard, mouse and joystick. Regardless of the type of device used they are all instruments of interpretation and communication between people and the computer.

Central Processing Unit (CPU): CPU is the heart of the computer which makes comparisons, performs calculations, reads, interprets and controls the execution of the instructions. it consists of three separate sub-units.

(1)The Control Unit – Control unit supervises the operations of the entire computer. The control unit instructs the input device when to start and stop transferring data to storage unit and it instructs the storage unit when to start and stop transferring data to output devices. Thus the control unit does not perform the actual processing operations of the data. Rather, its function is to maintain order and direct the flow of sequence of operations and data within the computer.

(2) The Arithmetic / Logic Unit: Arithmetic and logic unit performs mathematical calculations, compares numeric and non-numeric values and makes decisions. The data flows between this unit and the storage unit during processing.

Storage: Storage consists of primary and secondary storage. Primary storage of the computer consists of the devices used to store the information which will be used during the computations. The storage section of the computer is also used to hold both intermediate and final results as the computer proceeds through the program. Common storage devices are RAM. Since the primary storage capacity of computers is limited it is not always possible to hold a large volume of data and instructions in the primary storage. Hence it becomes necessary to have secondary or auxiliary storage for holding data and programs not currently in use. The various secondary storage devices are CD, DVD, USB flash drive (Pendrive), Hard disk etc.

Output Devices: Output devices are used to record the results obtained by the computer and present them to the outside world. They take information in machine coded form from storage unit and convert them typically into a form that can be used i.e. printed forms. The most commonly used output devices are printers, visual display unit, monitor etc.

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